something we are perfectly allowed to object to, even if we won't be around to be bothered by it once it happens. And given that, quantum suicide turns out to be just as bleak and unpalatable as our immediate intuition might suggest. It's okay for me to yearn for a happy and long life for all the future versions of me that will end up in various branches of the wave function, as much as it would be valid for me to hope for a long life if I thought there was just a single world.

This goes back to something we discussed in Chapter Seven: the importance of treating individuals on different branches of the wave function as distinct persons, even if they descended from the same individual in the past. There is an important asymmetry between how we think about "our future" versus "our past" in Many-Worlds, which ultimately can be attributed to the low-entropy condition of our early universe. Any one individual can trace their lives backward in a unique person, but going forward in time we will branch into multiple people. There is not one future self that is picked out as "really you," and it's equally true that there is no one person constituted by all of those future individuals. They are separate, as much as identical twins are distinct people, despite descending from a single zygote.

We might care about what happens to the versions of ourselves who live on other branches, but it's not sensible to think of them as "us." Imagine that you're just about to perform a vertical-spin measurement on an electron you have prepared in an equal superposition of spin-up and spin-down. A random philanthropist enters your lab and offers you the following bargain: if the spin is up, they will give you a million dollars; if the spin is down, you give them one dollar. You would be wise to take the deal; for all intents and purposes, it's as if you are being offered a bet with equal chances of winning a million dollars or losing just one dollar, even if one of your future selves will certainly be out a dollar.

But now imagine that you were a little quicker in your experimental setup, and you observed a spin-down outcome just before the philanthropist busts in. It turns out that they are a pushy deal-maker, and they explain that the version of you on the other branch is being given a million dollars, but you now have to give them one dollar in this branch.

There's no reason for you to be happy about this (or to give up the dollar), even though the version of you on the other branch might be happy about it. You are not them, and they are not part of you. Post-branching,